

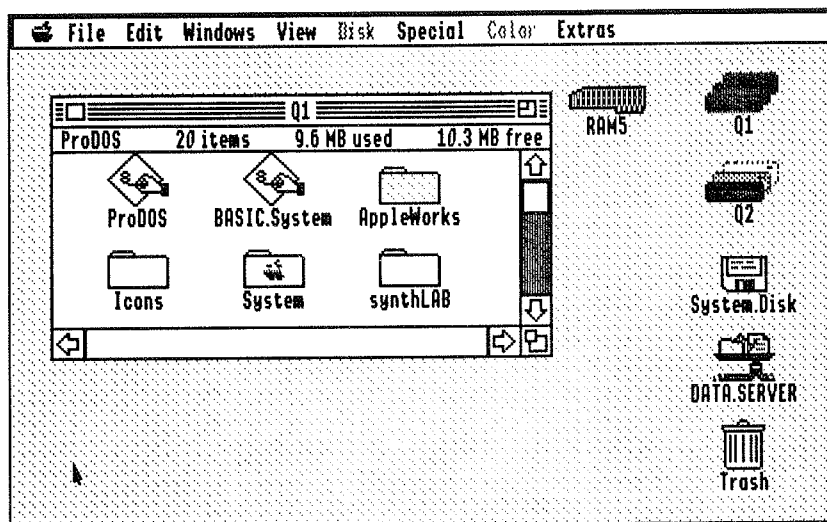


Figure 3A—Sample Desktop Screen (from Finder)

▲ By The Way...

The AppleWorks desktop, in case you haven't guessed, is not at all related to the desktop metaphor we're talking about in this book. The AppleWorks desktop is just a place to store your files while you're working on them. The Apple Desktop is a much more general concept—it's a way of interacting with your computer.

The Desktop's menu bar is its main menu—it lists all the *kinds* of things you can do in the program you're using. In the Finder, the things you can do are divided into the categories of File, Edit, Windows, View, Disk, Special, and Color. The rainbow-colored 🍏 symbol to the left of the File is also a menu. We'll explain how to use the menus and the options in them a little later; for now, it's enough to realize that the menus are there.

The menu bar is almost always visible in a Desktop program. That's one of the basic ideas of the Desktop—to make it clear at all times what you can do next. The menu bar takes up very little space on the screen when you're not using it, but you can glance at it (or even browse through it) at any time to remind yourself what options are available.

Another fundamental Desktop element is the window. A sample Finder window occupies most of the middle of the screen. The Finder uses windows to represent the contents of a disk. Like most Desktop windows, the Finder's windows can be moved, resized, opened, closed, and scrolled. You can also open more than one window. (We'll get into window manipulation shortly.) What you see in a window is called, naturally, a view.